Caldwell & Mr Pratt.

Code July 21

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United States Consulate

Amoy, June 30th 1874

Mr J. J. Henderson, Consul

To the Department of State.

Subject

Japanese invasion of Formosa—
Complicity of Citizens of the United
States.

Contents

Repat of a conversation with the
local authorities.

No 31

United States Consulate
Amoy, June 3rd 1874

Hon: J. C. B. Davis.
Asst Secy of State
Washington D.C.

Sir,

Since sending my dispatch No 30 with reference to the Japanese invasion of Formosa, I had a long conversation with the Chinese Admiral and Taotai at this port on that subject and particularly the complicity of certain prominent Americans in the affair. The Taotai thought it a matter of common notoriety that Americans were taking part, and a very active one too, and remarked that it had frequently been stated in the newspapers that the expedition had been concocted and was being managed by Americans. They professed to regard America as China's oldest and truest friend; and thought justice and good faith demanded that our Government should at once

prevents its citizens from taking any
part in the performance. The Admiral
made a special request that I would
do what I could to bring about an
amicable settlement of the trouble
that would be just and honorable
to China

I cannot help thinking it,
a little unfortunate for appearance
sake at least, that citizens of the
first Government in the great family
of nations just now trying to teach
China international rights and
obligations, should be about the only
foreigners implicated and especially that so
many of them until quite recently
held responsible positions in our
Civil and military service, and
particularly that one of them is
now a Lieutenant Commander in
our Navy.

I assured them that it had
always been the pride of the United
States to maintain a scrupulously
impartial neutrality, in difficulties
between other nations in which they
had

no concern, and that when apprised
of any unlawful conduct on the
part of either their officers & citizens
in China, would inquire into the
matter and do justice; but as yet I
had no certain information that
Americans were taking any part
in the transaction other than that
of innocent observers.

That I had been over to For-
mosa to see for myself what was going
on, but the weather was so stormy
I was obliged to return without landing,
and until I received the Taotai's
letter on the subject a day or two ago,
I was not aware that China claimed
the savage territory at all, and had
been so informed by a high officer in
their service; that besides all this
it had frequently been stated in
newspapers that the Japanese had
gone to Formosa with the express
consent of the Government at Peking.
They both claimed to have authority
from Peking to declare the latter
report untrue.

The

character and sources of the information I have received about this affair until within the last four or five days has not seemed to justify me in taking any official notice of it; and judging from what I know of the history of Formosa and its savage inhabitants I was disposed to believe that China had given permission to the Japanese to go there and punish the savages, and really supposed she would be glad of it, if they had to be punished at all. But after what developed in the conversation yesterday, I concluded this morning to telegraph to the Legation for instructions as to course to pursue towards Americans implicated, and did so.

I have the honor to be
Sir,
Your obedient Servt
J. J. Rudyard
U. S. Consul.

Inclosure
1. Correspondence from Japanese Camp in Formosa.

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From The Daily Press,

HONGKONG, JUNE 2nd, 1874.

THE WAR IN FORMOSA.

(From our Special Correspondent.)

JAPANESE CAMP,
LANGKIAOU, 21st MAY, 1874.

Langkiaou, where the Japanese are encamped, is a small plain one or two square miles in extent and surrounded by hills, on the West Coast of Formosa, about ten miles from the South Cape, and forty miles from Takow. There are a few Chinese villages in it. Communication with the North is generally by junk, as the path through the hills is not safe from attack.

The Japanese have lately been busily occupied in changing the position of their camp. The old one was on an open level plain that answered capitally till the rain began to fall, when the unfortunate soldiers found themselves sleeping literally in water. The new camp is on a line of sand hills nearer the shore, and less regular, but far more healthy and comfortable. In spite of the work and the rain, a few small parties have managed to get away into the bush to try their breech-loaders on the savages. Two or three men have thus fallen on both sides. On one occasion such a large party of savages jumped out upon six Japanese that they had to run, leaving one of their number on the ground. His head now decorates some savage hut. Let us hope that it will be the only trophy of the kind that the savages will gain in the war. The tribe against whom proceedings are carried on are supposed to be the actual murderers of the Lewchewans, and are called the Botan, or the "peony," savages.

There are two American officers here, Commodore Cassell and Colonel Wasson. Such at least is the rank which they bear while serving the Japanese. They seem to have had hitherto, in an unofficial way, the general direction of the expedition; and, unless they belie their reputation, they will do good service in the war. These two gentlemen the other day went unattended by an escort to a neighbouring savage village to see the chief. It had been agreed that they should meet in the open country; but the savages not appearing, the officers went on to the village. This was an act requiring more nerve and real courage than some dashing exploit on the battlefield. A peaceable arrangement was made, which included all the villages South of Langkiaou, except one which is to be punished for some act of hostility.

22nd May.

This morning early the later sleepers among us were awakened by a salute of several guns. This announced the arrival of General Saigo, the Commander-in chief of the expedition. He came in the *Delta*, which also brought 1,200 troops. A Japanese gunboat came in at the same time, and an hour or two afterwards the *Shaftesbury*, with 600 soldiers, raising the number to about 2,500. 3,000 are expected in all. The *Delta* is said to have been bought standing, with her fittings and stores, and apparently officers as well; for they are all on board, though a new Captain commands her. A fine Chinese corvette, the *Yang Woo*, and a small gunboat, have also come in, bringing three Chinese Mandarins from Taiwanfoo to visit the Japanese Commander-in-chief. With the four Japanese vessels and H.M.S. *Hornet*, which have been here for some days, there are, therefore, ten

steamers anchored together in the bay.

A small party of troops bivouacked last night in the mountains, about four miles away. Early this afternoon two men were seen coming in wounded. At the same time about one hundred men hurried off to take part in the fighting. They were in irregular detachments, apparently without any officers. They went along at a half run as eager and delighted as possible. Many of them were carrying their two [illegible] awkward enough for scrambling through the bush; but the Japanese cannot bear to leave them behind, hoping that some time or other they may come up with the savages. If they do, there will be fearful work. It is a common sight to see men employing their leisure moments in sharpening and resharpening their sabres or sword bayonets. They think breech-loaders are excellent weapons for fighting at a distance, but they have a most blood thirsty longing for hand to hand work.

23rd May.

We hear this morning that the result of yesterday's fight was fifteen savages and six Japanese killed on the spot. A visit to the hospital showed ten wounded men there, one, and perhaps two, mortally hurt. The Japanese brought in all their men who were killed, and cut off and carried back the heads of the savages, which however were immediately buried. One of the savages killed was a chief, and in his pouch was found a quantity of percussion caps, but he was fighting with a matchlock! The work was severe. The savages generally waited under cover, rising up suddenly and firing first, and then running away to take up a fresh position. In one place, a slight stockade was erected across a ravine, and a stand was made there. The Japanese are extremely brave. The only fault to be found with them is that they are too regardless of their own lives, preferring to rush in rather than to adopt the savage tactics, and make the most of the cover.

The Chinese inhabitants are both delighted and astonished at this slaughtering of their enemies. They are on excellent terms with the Japanese, who, with equal justice and wisdom, pay well for everything they want. The Chinese do not well understand the big copper coins, but thoroughly appreciate the new silver currency.

The Chinese Mandarins come on shore to-day at noon, to see the Commander-in-chief. They were received by a guard of honour of two hundred soldiers. The visit was very short. It is not known what passed. The Mandarins were not of sufficiently high rank for the Japanese to be willing to discuss anything of importance with them; and probably not much took place beyond an interchange of compliments.

We are having a sample of Formosa weather. In the morning, though the sea was quiet, still there was a surf which rendered care necessary in landing. This afternoon in an incredibly short space of time, such a sea has got up that the two small gunboats are rolling almost gunwales under, and communication between the shore and the ships is a matter of real difficulty. Cloudy weather, with a mixture of drizzling rain and heavy down-pour, rend r fever and ague a too probable contingency.

The Japanese commanders do not want to have any more fighting for two or three days, fearing to frighten the enemy away. They wish to wait till they can attack from several quarters at once, and so have a chance of preventing the escape of the savages.

The *Nepaul* sails to-night for Nagasaki.